Address to a Joint Session of Congress after 9/11

President George W. Bush · September 20, 2001

Source: George W. Bush, Address to a Joint Session of Congress (2001). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Nine days after the September 11 attacks, Bush declared a global “war on terror,” demanded the Taliban surrender al Qaeda, and warned every nation that “either you are with us, or you are with the terrorists.”

Americans are asking, why do they hate us? They hate what we see right here in this chamber — a democratically elected government. Their leaders are self-appointed. They hate our freedoms — our freedom of religion, our freedom of speech, our freedom to vote and assemble and disagree with each other.

[. . .]

Every nation, in every region, now has a decision to make. Either you are with us, or you are with the terrorists. . . . Freedom and fear are at war. . . . We will not tire, we will not falter, and we will not fail.